Supplementary information

Companion to: Decoy artifacts and limited source-disjoint affinity prediction in a TCR-pMHC computational workflow.

S1. Scope and chronology

This is a retrospective, single-project analysis. Evidence was known before the manuscript analysis plan. The plan adds fixed descriptive aggregation and public coordinate replication; it is not described as a prospectively registered hypothesis test. The underlying affinity experiment was planned and model-locked before its test was opened. The bounded development experiment used a separate plan and did not reevaluate the consumed test.

Historical chronology is retained in Git: 0b8e6acf3fc56a628e6434f6985022e959117603 fixed the affinity protocol; c0c2095762950b212001dffd84600c6ec59d5083 locked the model before test access; b59b5da6240f0583cb5832407e5c2a8e1b804bf0 retained the completed acceptance. Later development plans were recorded at 7f8e9b1 and d41af3d before fitting the bounded alternatives. The present report uses the e4d68de evidence snapshot. These are version-controlled project records, not an external clinical-trial registration.

The current manuscript builder reads fifteen enumerated report/protocol JSON files. It never imports a training or scoring entry point, decodes individual test predictions, or accesses the fresh reserve. No threshold or model is selected for a better manuscript outcome. The previous test remains consumed and the fresh reserve remains unavailable for tuning.

S2. Structural construction evidence

Table S1. Fixed severe-overlap screen. Percentages describe records in this collection. Audit families are inherited groups and are not biological replicates.

Kind	Records	Audit families	Overlap flags	Record rate	Family mean	Incomplete interface
native	300	86	0	0.00%	0.00%	9
graft	288	83	146	50.69%	57.99%	9
displaced	300	86	300	100.00%	100.00%	9

The native/displacement sets span 86 inherited families and the graft set 83. Repetition within a family is retained. Equal-family weighting means averaging the within-family flag fractions; it does not make families representative of a population. Rows and all 588 parent-control mappings are supplied in structural_qc.csv, family_qc.csv and paired_qc.csv.

Table S2. Fixed QC-only rule on paired native/control records. A record is called synthetic if it contains a flagged severe cross-chain distance. Balanced accuracy is (sensitivity + specificity)/2. There is no fitted threshold, held-out construction test, biological class assignment, or inference of a neural model's learned mechanism.

Control	Parent-control pairs	Sensitivity	Specificity	Balanced accuracy
graft	288	0.506944	1.000000	0.753472
displaced	300	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000

The public atomic_inputs.json.gz archive contains the 300 reconstructed source complexes and peptide coordinates for every historical native/control record. Each source is linked to a source-file SHA256, basename, domain and PDB code. Every graph retains the source complex ID, construction kind, inherited family, node keys and donor ID where applicable. Coordinates are serialized without additional decimal rounding. Source material is derivative PDB/prediction input, not new wet-laboratory evidence.

During export, the existing construction helper reproduced all 888 retained screen reports and their interface-missing-atom lists. The independent distance checker reads only this archive and the original audit JSON, uses a Python standard-library spatial cell-grid implementation, and confirms the count of every peptide-environment heavy-atom pair at <=1.2 A. It does not use torch models or download original structures. Agreement between two implementations is a reproducibility check; it does not validate the cutoff's biological meaning. The exporter reads only the project's own trusted pickle cache and is not suitable for arbitrary untrusted torch files.

S3. Structural repair dispositions

The historical 888 records were not repurposed as binding labels. The 588 synthetic controls were retired; 168 native assets were retained without response labels; 132 native records were not admitted under the new policy. Their reasons included 97 contact-screen exclusions, nine incomplete interfaces, 25 predicted identity/reference-QC failures, and one changed historical-reference attribution. These categories describe policy decisions and do not prove that every excluded source structure is experimentally wrong. The new five construction pairs have no calibration/test pairs. No repaired structural-model accuracy is claimed.

S4. Counting units and grouping sensitivity

Table S3. Actual panel counts. Full-construct identity and similarity are distinct from independently annotated variable-region or V-gene families.

Unit	Count
FASTA files	347
PDB prefixes	111
Exact receptor pairs	98
Hamming components	89
Matching-block components	57

All 347 FASTA hashes are retained in the pinned pending_panel.json, alongside sequences and the first committed version. There are 91 peptide strings, 85 alpha strings, 76 beta strings, 45 MHC strings and 11 B2M strings. Component counts can differ because changing the pairwise comparison creates different graph edges and transitive links. Neither 89 nor 57 is promoted as the correct biological family count, and the unavailable 73-cluster algorithm was not reconstructed by tuning these rules.

S5. Affinity evaluation and bounded development

Table S4. Already-completed locked affinity experiment. All errors are in pKD. Test metrics use equal total source weight, equal lineage weight within each source, and equal observation weight within each lineage. The source groups are coauthor-connected components. No new per-observation predictions were made to construct this table.

Subset	Method	Observations	Lineages	Sources	RMSE	MAE
primary	Ridge	14	7	3	0.996215	0.848597
primary	Training mean	14	7	3	1.003632	0.853082
sensitivity	Ridge	15	7	3	1.024121	0.876009
sensitivity	Training mean	15	7	3	1.031228	0.880495
Baker-linked	Ridge	5	4	1	1.116805	1.014953
Baker-linked	Training mean	5	4	1	1.127836	1.012459
Immunocore	Ridge	7	2	1	1.178506	0.992569
Immunocore	Training mean	7	2	1	1.179479	0.992258
Wu et al.	Ridge	2	1	1	0.584124	0.538268
Wu et al.	Training mean	2	1	1	0.598871	0.554530

Table S5. Primary studies underlying the external affinity panel. Variant names are not counted as independent receptor lineages. Full measurement-specific peptide, sequence, orientation, fit and source locators are preserved in the existing frozen records; this manuscript does not amend those records.

PMID	First author	Year	DOI
33468649	Smith AR	2021	10.1073/pnas.2018125118
35484264	Chandran SS	2022	10.1038/s41591-022-01786-3
39042676	Gaglione SA	2024	10.1073/pnas.2406615121
39500929	Karuppiah V	2024	10.1038/s41598-024-75140-7
39576860	Wu D	2024	10.1126/sciadv.adq6150

The coauthor graph joins the Smith, Chandran and Gaglione studies into one source component. Karuppiah and Wu form the other two components. Same-study, receptor-chain similarity and peptide similarity also define four connected test blocks. The use of source components is conservative; author-name ambiguity and incomplete provenance remain possible. Sharing a V gene alone is not an exclusion under the retained protocol, so this is not V-gene-disjoint testing.

The original training and validation sets each had ten observations and five connected blocks. The later bounded development experiment excluded ATLAS:485 from validation before candidate fitting because its source overlapped a new reserve. The remaining nine validation observations occupy four blocks. All original remaining folds and blocks were preserved, with no reshuffling to increase independent counts.

Table S6. All fixed development candidates on the nine-observation validation set. Alphas of new candidates were selected inside the five inherited training blocks only. The reference retains its previous configuration-selection history.

Candidate	Alpha	Validation RMSE	Validation MAE	Prediction SD
anchor_raw	1.0	0.772873	0.599472	0.260809
sequence_balanced	100.0	0.793244	0.663391	0.026379
cdr3_chemical	0.1	0.917451	0.873417	0.278756
cdr3_words	0.1	0.907292	0.862141	0.272811
Training mean	N/A	0.802913	0.666416	0.000000

The 1,014-feature reference includes one/two-residue frequencies, length terms, composition-product interactions, MHC indicators, instrument indicators and temperature terms. The chemical variants and group normalization are fully defined in the versioned plan_v2.json and development_affinity.py. Their results do not establish a population ranking of representations. Unseen vocabulary entries are ignored at application; the small sample and its assay composition leave substantial uncertainty about transferability.

S6. Historical score provenance

The five-seed reconstruction covered 188 jobs, 884 AF3 structures, 940 job-by-seed means and 4,420 structure-by-seed scores. The retained four-decimal matches were 938/940 and 4,417/4,420. All discrepancies are 0.0001 at the reported precision, with causes not yet isolated. Fourteen jobs have only one retained AF3 input; they do not provide five-model variability estimates. The separate 21-job scoring table cannot yet be bound to its original checkpoint.

The audit's historical numeric results remain marked FORENSIC_WITHDRAWN. Present-day reconstruction is not evidence of the exact historical command or file overwrite order. No historical clinical ranking is reinstated. MAG-IC3 and a3a are distinct engineered constructs, and near scores are not a statistical equivalence test.

S7. Evidence tiers and availability

Tier A: all manuscript tables and figures can be regenerated from tracked, hash-pinned reports. Tier B: all severe-distance counts can be recomputed from the tracked 28.3-MB coordinate archive, using a second algorithm. Tier C: full historical neural-score replay additionally needs old checkpoints and 884 input files; the hashes and local replay results are tracked, but the complete Tier C inputs are not included in this manuscript package. No claim of complete public Tier C replication is made.

The old learned model and clinical interpretation are not required to substantiate the narrow Tier A/B results. Full coordinate-to-source identity can be checked against the recorded original-file hashes when those inputs are available. That chain does not remove sequence/role ambiguities already disclosed in the historical audit.

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S8. Reproduction commands

From the repository root, choose fresh output paths. Existing result directories are deliberately not overwritten.

```
python docs/preprint_20261021/build_evidence.py --out /tmp/meta-acdc-paper-report

python docs/preprint_20261021/verify_atomic_inputs.py --bundle
docs/preprint_20261021/atomic_bundle_v1 --out /tmp/meta-acdc-atom-check.json
```

```
PYTHONPATH=src python -m unittest discover -s tests -p test_preprint_evidence.py -v
```

The report builder uses Python's standard library and Matplotlib. Coordinate verification uses only the Python standard library. The existing historical fit environment is recorded in its fit_report.json; no training should be restarted with the consumed test profile. The PDF renderer additionally uses ReportLab and records its dependencies. Packages were reused from existing environments, with no installation in this round.

S9. Submission and author review

The author has confirmed single authorship and will provide identifying details later. The draft requires substantive human review of proposed interpretations, author contributions, funding and conflicts before submission. AI assistance is disclosed for analysis code and drafting. It is not sufficient to add a name to an unreviewed AI-generated discussion.

On 20 October 2026, openRxiv published a statement requiring verifiable human authors with an organizational affiliation to which research-integrity concerns can be directed. Eligibility of an unaffiliated independent researcher therefore needs confirmation before submission; no institution or collaboration is fabricated. This administrative issue does not change the measured results. Current official policy is recorded in submission_readiness.json and the submission guide.